Swati Hira
Department of Computer Science and Engineering
IIIT Nagpur, Nagpur, India
shira@iiitn.ac.in

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The Editor-in-Chief
Remote Sensing Letters
Taylor & Francis

Dear Editor,

We submit the manuscript **"Does channel attention help few-label hyperspectral CNNs? A controlled comparison finds no gain that transfers across scenes or protocols"** for consideration as a Research Letter in *Remote Sensing Letters*.

Channel-attention blocks are frequently proposed for lightweight hyperspectral classifiers, and their gains are usually reported on random pixel splits in which overlapping patches leak spatial context into the test set. Leakage itself has been documented for whole architectures; whether the *choice of block* still matters once evaluation is tightened has, to our knowledge, not been tested with paired statistics. Our letter does this:

- Seven modulation blocks (SE, ECA, CBAM, GCT, SRM and two variants of a dispersion-aware block we introduce, SNSM) are compared on one backbone with identical inputs and schedule, no test-based model selection, up to fifteen paired seeds, bootstrap intervals and Holm-corrected Wilcoxon tests, under six protocols that vary class counts and spatial overlap.
- No block gives a gain that transfers. The one effect we find, a 2–4 point advantage of dispersion-based gates on random Indian Pines splits, comes from three classes with one or two training pixels and does not reappear when the same scarcity is imposed on Pavia University or Kennedy Space Center; under patch-disjoint splits the protocol itself moves accuracy by more than 30 points.
- We show that the commonly distributed Kennedy Space Center file stores small negative values as unsigned integers, a problem earlier reported as sensor saturation, and that reading it correctly raises convolutional models from 77–92% to over 99% average accuracy.

We believe these results suit the journal's readership because they bear directly on how new modules for hyperspectral classification are evaluated and compared. The findings are short, self-contained and supported by complete code and per-run results, which are publicly available at `https://github.com/Devguru-codes/research_paper_code`.

The manuscript is original, has not been published previously and is not under consideration elsewhere. All authors have approved the submission. The authors declare no competing interests, and the research received no external funding. Generative AI was used to assist with experiment code, reference checking and language editing, as stated in the manuscript; the authors verified all content and take full responsibility for it.

Thank you for considering our work.

Yours sincerely,

Swati Hira (corresponding author), on behalf of Devguru Tiwari, Pratibha Kokardekar and S. R. Sathe